

SHOWCASE

The Moon

If you've started going smart with your home then maybe you're looking for a cool hub to go with your smart home. Here's one you might be interested in, The Moon from 1-Ring that we came across on Indiegogo.

What makes The Moon so cool? Well, for one thing it's levitating. Yes, levitating! It's a 360-degree smart camera which has both day and night vision, it charges wirelessly, it comes with cloud storage, and it's got a host of other sensors to monitor the happenings in your house. It's got voice recognition built into it as well.

Thanks to the fact that it's floating(!) it can quite smoothly rotate around and get a full 360-degree scan of its surroundings. It's a smart home hub, so it integrates with your other smart home devices and is compatible with Google Home and Alexa. They say that they're bringing in support for Apple's Homekit soon as well.

The Moon comes with a speaker and three microphones as well, so it can be used for voice chat. Its wide-angle lens can detect and record automatically if its sensors pick up sounds and motion in the room.

The Moon's expected to be available in March next year at \$330; it's still live on Indiegogo. If things go well, this is a pretty neat hub to have.



Nissha Mui

Created by Kyoto-based company Nissha, the same people behind the capacitive touch sensors in the Nintendo Switch, Mui is an interactive display that looks like, well, looks like a block of wood.

It's a very attractive looking block of wood though, in its defence, or it wouldn't be here in the first place.

But that's not all. The Mui can do much, much more, from controlling your light settings, setting the temperature and showing you your messages. It's a great, aesthetically pleasing addition to your smart home. And it blends in with most modern interior designs.



The word Mui comes from the Japanese word meaning 'silence'. It's quite apt for this block of wood which blends in till it's needed. It integrates well with current smart home systems, i.e., Google Home and Alexa. It also contains a CO2 sensor to get a report on the weather. But the 1.2kg weight might be an issue to some. With a max power consumption of a mere 50W, Mui is also economical if you decide to go for it. It is expected to launch sometime in June next year, i.e 2018 at the \$900 - \$1200 price range.

Curious Chip Pip

The Pip by Curious Chip is a handheld device which allows you to create games and apps on it.

The device is powered by Raspberry Pi and the device itself packs a touchscreen, speaker, control buttons, different ports and coloured LEDs as well. There are certain options that come with a camera as well.

What's cool about the Pip is that it not only looks like a handheld console, it actually is one! You can play classics on the Pip like Snake and Pac-Man, you can even play Minecraft.



This is in addition to being able to code and create games on it from scratch. There are a selection of games and apps that are bundled with the Pip and if you want more, you can go check out their online arcade.

Pip uses a platform called Curiosity, which gives users access to tutorials and projects, complete with step by step instructions so kids can learn to code at their own pace. It's a neat way for kids to learn to code in multiple languages.

The Pip isn't restricted to just kids, you can work on more advanced code as well using the Pip. Pip is completely open and is made using off-the-shelf materials, leading to it's fairly cheap price as well, with it retailing at £269 (₹23,150). It's estimated to start retailing sometime later next year.